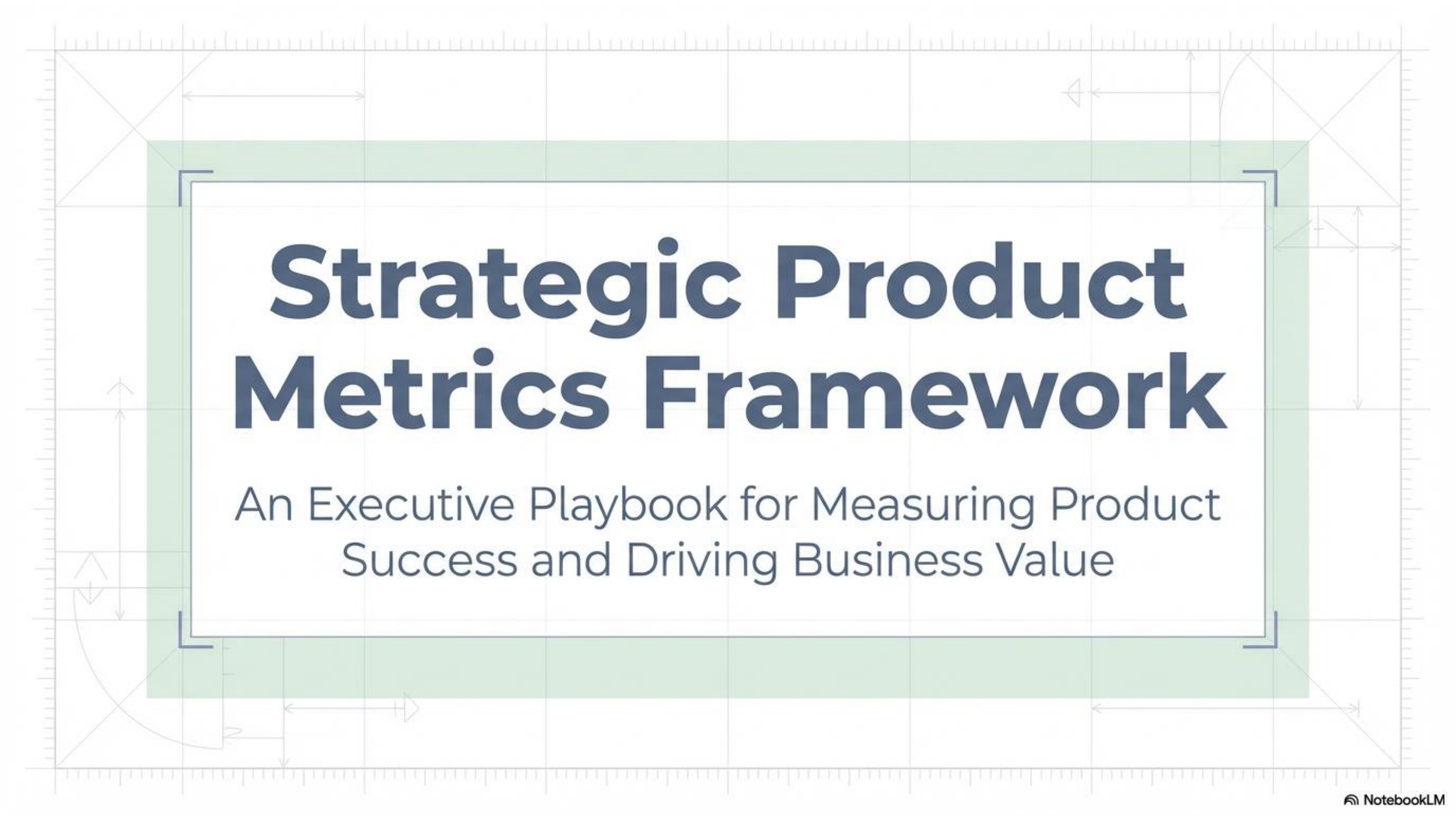


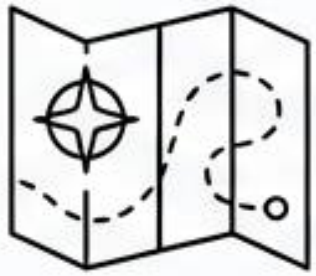


Strategic Product Metrics Framework

An Executive Playbook for Measuring Product Success and Driving Business Value

The Product Evaluation Playbook

A standardized methodology to align product performance with business outcomes.



01: Contextualize

Define user segments, isolate friction, and map marketplace dynamics.



02: Define

Establish the North Star metric based on the product's ideal state.



03: Map

Track 1-3 targeted metrics across the sequential user journey.



04: Evaluate

Rigorously pressure-test metrics for confidence, product stage, and operational cadence.

Pillar 1: Product & Audience Context

Before defining metrics, clearly map the value proposition and target segments.

① Identify Pain Points

What specific friction does this product eliminate for the user?

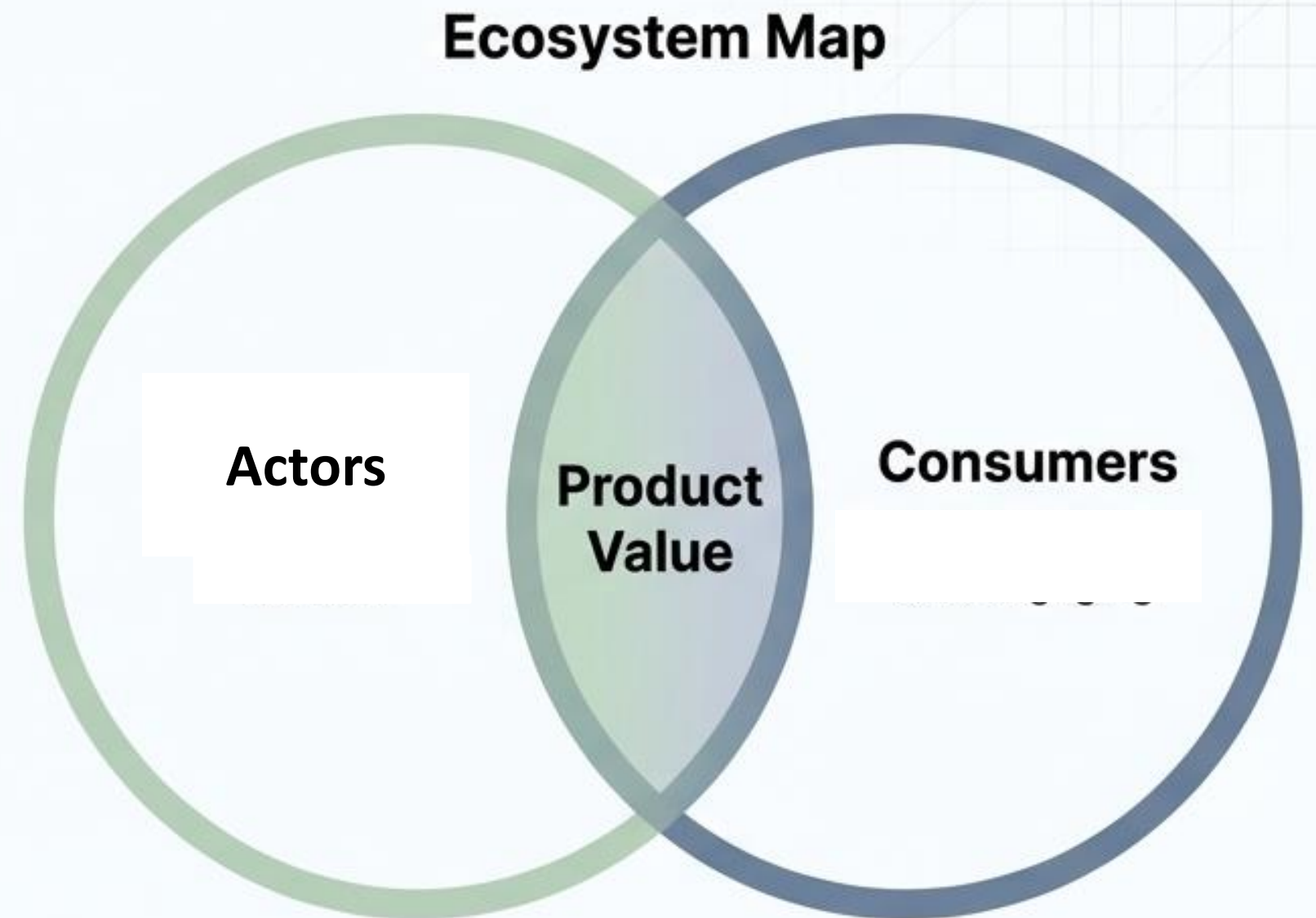
② Define the Users

Who is actively engaging with the product?

③ Segment the Ecosystem

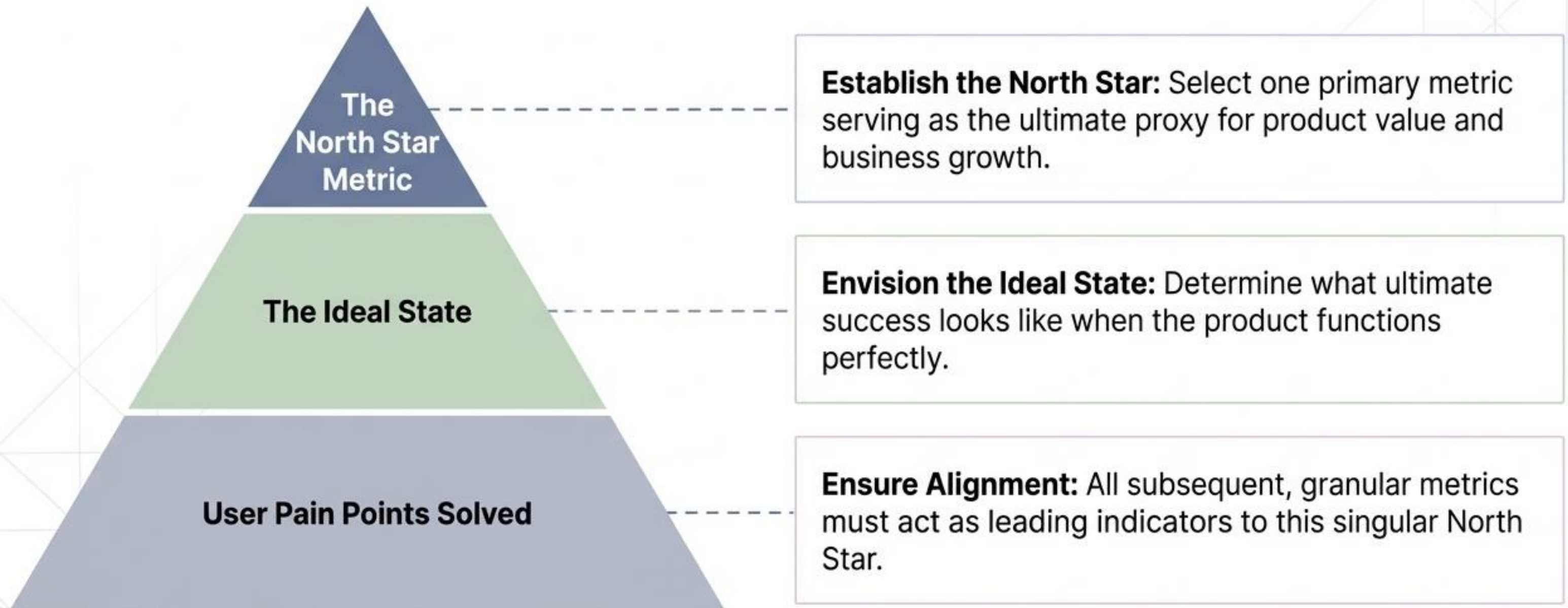
Marketplace/platform products require distinct, bifurcated metrics.

Case Study (Instagram Reels): Metrics must be separated between Creators and Consumers.



Pillar 2: Defining the North Star

Anchor all product efforts to a singular metric that defines the “Ideal State.”



Pillar 3: Mapping the User Journey

Break down the user experience into measurable, sequential steps.

Track the Steps: Define exactly how a user navigates the product from entry to exit.

Execute the Rule of Thumb: Assign 1-3 specific, trackable metrics to each crucial step in the mapped journey.

Case Study: Instagram Reels Flow



Entry

User taps the Reels tab or navigates via the Discover feed.



Action

User scrolls downward for continuous content delivery.

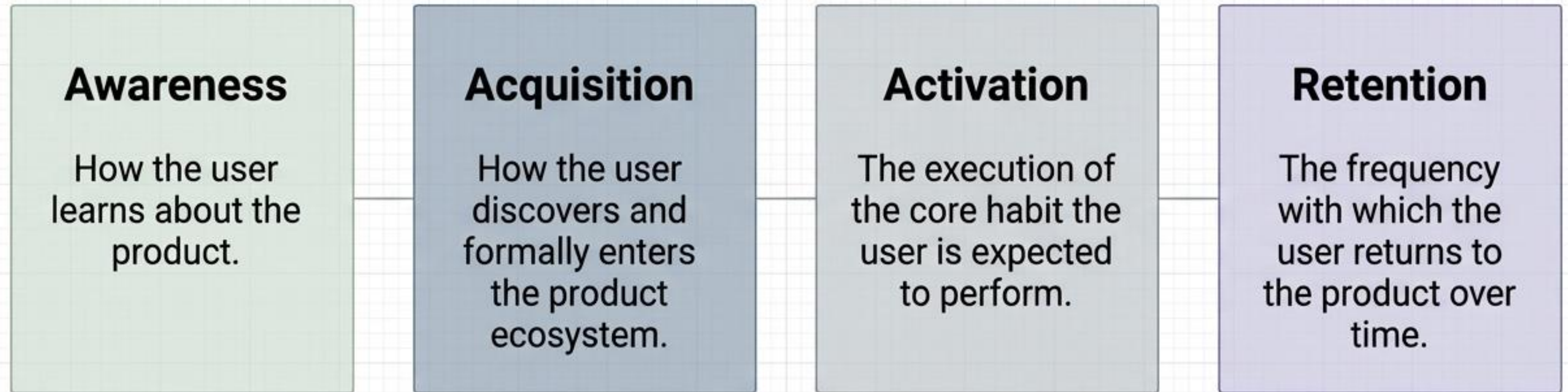


Engagement

User executes definitive actions

The Metrics Landscape: Discovery & Habit

Standardizing metrics across the top-of-funnel and core usage loop.



The Metrics Landscape: Value & Growth

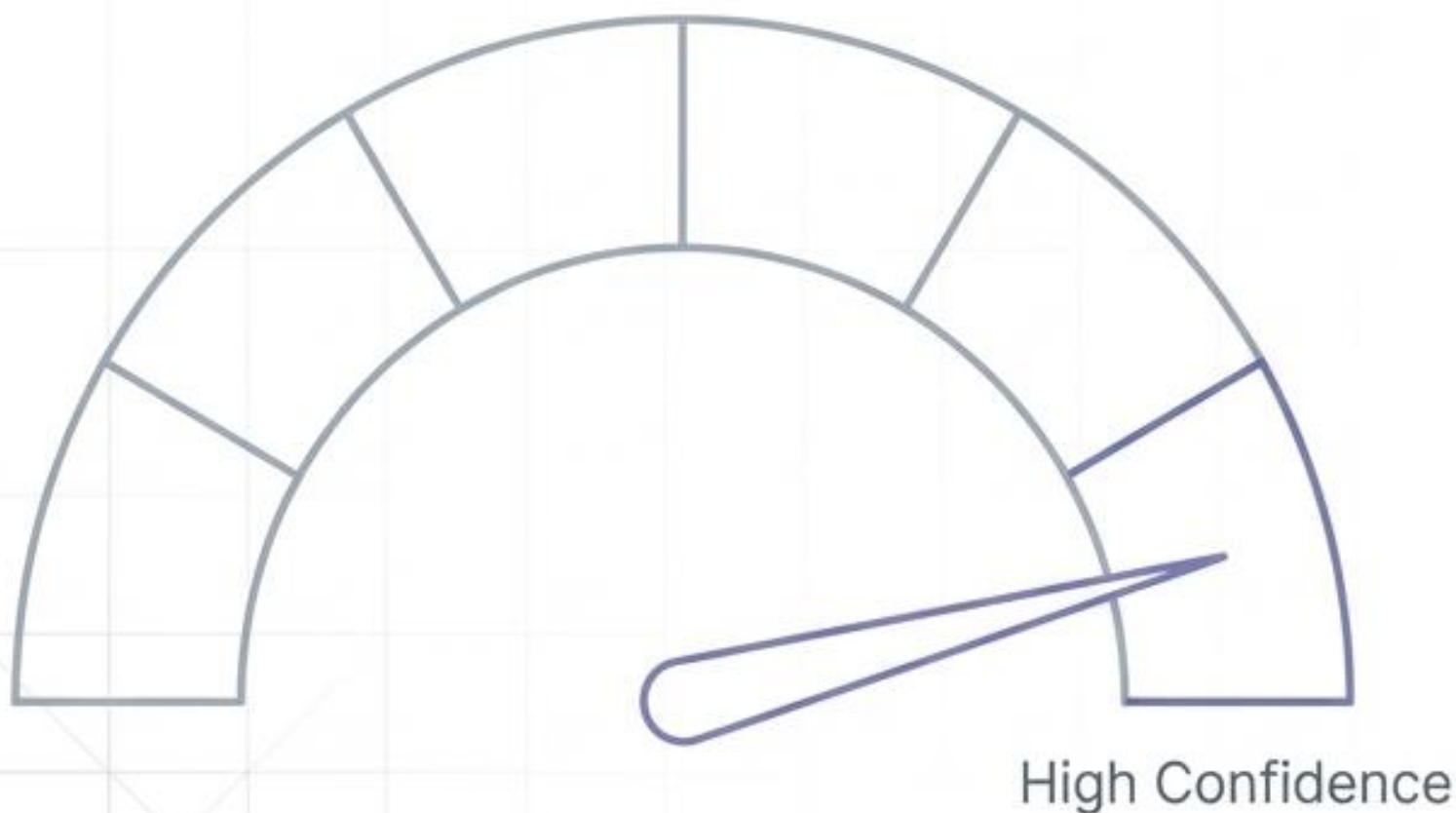
Standardizing metrics across deep usage and business ROI.



Strategic Imperative: Do not force-fit. Not all stages are relevant for every product; map only what drives the North Star.

Pillar 4: Evaluating Metric Quality

Do not track everything; track only what can be measured accurately and actioned upon.



Assess Confidence

Can this metric be measured with high data integrity and accuracy?



Avoid Vanity

If a metric cannot be measured confidently, discard it immediately or engineer a valid proxy.



Classify Hierarchy

Separate key metrics (primary indicators) from sub-metrics (diagnostic data points) to avoid noise.

Product Lifecycle Diagnostic Matrix

Metric prioritization must adapt to the maturity stage of the product.

Early-Stage Products

Primary Focus

Proving baseline value and capturing initial market share.

Critical Journey Stages

Awareness, Acquisition, Activation.

Late-Stage / Mature Products

Primary Focus

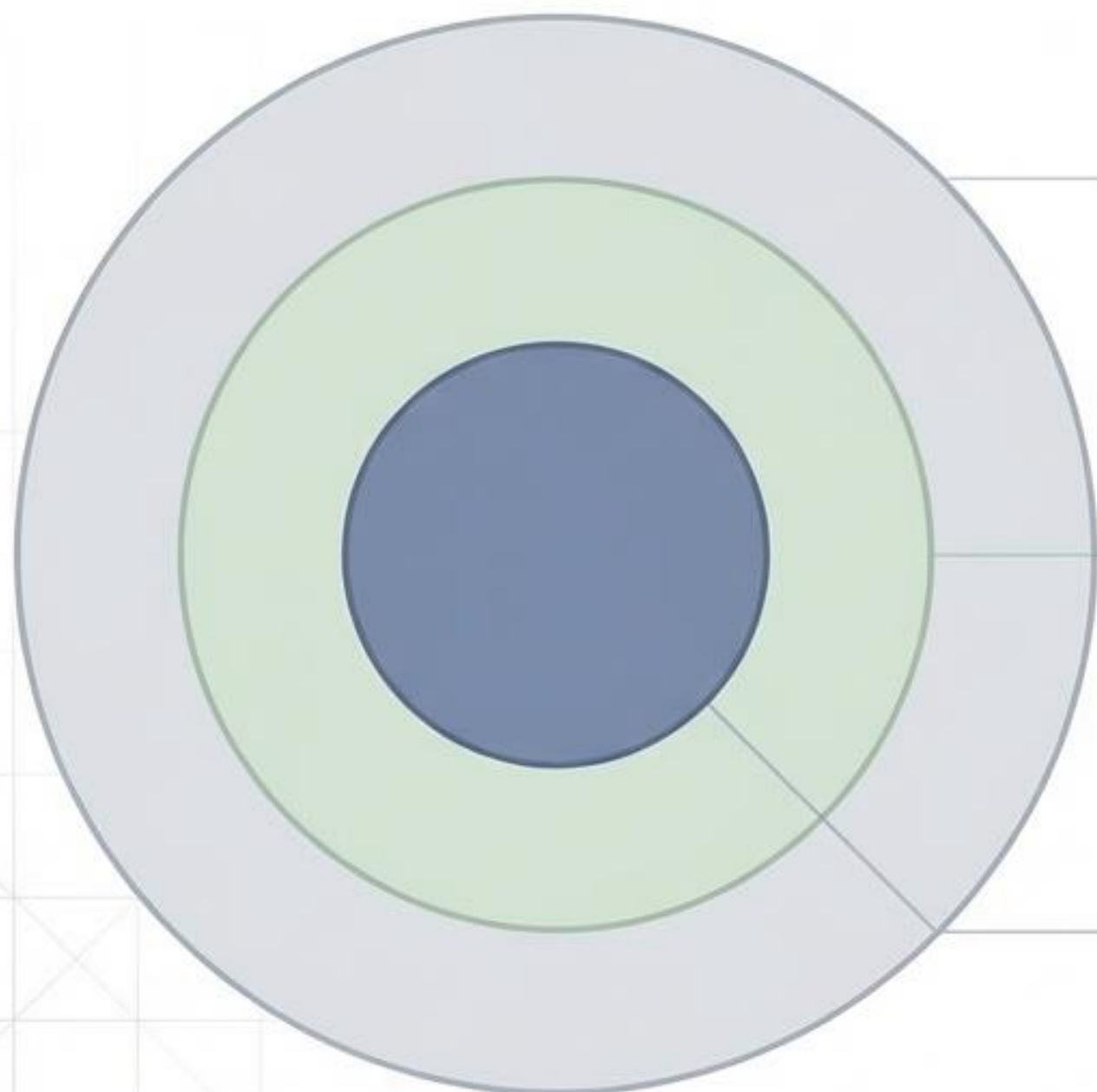
Maximizing lifetime value, profitability, and ecosystem stickiness.

Critical Journey Stages

Retention, Engagement, Monetisation.

The Operational Cadence Framework

Structuring when and how leadership reviews metric performance.



Monthly Review

The North Star metric and aggregate Monetisation outcomes.

Owned by CEO & Executive Team

Weekly Review

Key journey metrics (e.g., Activation, Retention) to track sprint-level impacts.

Owned by Directors & VPs

Daily Review

Sub-metrics and highly volatile engagement indicators.

Owned by Line Managers & Product Leads

Implementation & Strategic Alignment

Driving executive alignment through disciplined measurement.

1 Define Before Measuring

Always isolate the distinct user segments and align on the "Ideal State" before opening a dashboard.

2 Map the Journey Sequence

Apply the 7-stage engine framework to identify exactly 1-3 actionable metrics per phase.

3 Prioritize Ruthlessly

Filter all metrics through the lenses of product lifecycle stage, measurement confidence, and operational review cadence.